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buy the install disc and install it in safe mode, or buy online from a clean PC, then download the setup and install it on the infected one. Which-ever scanner you use though remember not to rush the scan. Go for the most thorough scan. The scan will (it should) take a few hours. So take off for the day. Take a road trip with your closest friends and remember to complain about how bad your PC's infection was, and remember who to thank for helping you fix it.



Clean using Ubuntu

If the safe mode method didn't work, and your problem is much bigger, i.e. your computer isn't booting and you don't have access to the OS. Well - be afraid. Be very afraid.

No, not really. Relax. It's probably a boot sector virus.

What is a boot sector virus? We're glad you asked.

A boot sector virus is a virus that places its own codes and commands into a harddrives's boot sector (also known as its Master Boot Record). When this kind of virus infects a system, the Master Boot Record usually gets corrupted. This means that the computer's boot sequence has changed.

Boot sector viruses can be dangerous and very creative. They are loaded onto a computer every time one starts up, and in time, they can spread to the rest of your disks. An infection by a boot sector virus generally leads to Booting and start up problems, instability in your computer's performance, data retrieval issues and the inability to detect your hard drives on your PC.

This problem, however tedious, is quite curable. Of course, there is the option of running a high-level format on the hard drive, and yes, that would fix your problem, but it would also wipe out any data that is on the drive. If you need to keep the data, the answer is quite simple: Ubuntu.

A Windows boot sector hard drive has no impact on the Linux kernel. Plugging in your hard drive into a PC which runs on Ubuntu and running one of its virus scans on it would do the trick. In case you don't have a Ubuntu PC handy, read Digit's last issue - the Workshop section has a handy method of installing Ubuntu on a pen drive.

Once you boot in Ubuntu, scan the hard drive with any number of the Linux-compatible antiviruses available.

Avast! and AVG both have Linux versions as well, and Bit-defender, ClamAV and F-Prot are good options too.

The Ubuntu method works for most Windows antivirus issues. If you want to be extremely sure that your PC is clean, we suggest you go through both techniques for a full cleanse.



Better safe than sorry

Though we've mentioned this several times above, remember, it's a lot better to get a full-fledged antivirus software to take care of your cleanup needs. Even after you disinfect your system, keep a keen eye open for virus issues, and keep running AV scans on your system regularly to make sure you're virus-free. You can never be too safe, and you will always be way too sorry.

TUMBLR

Tumblr though technically a blogging platform, has over the years evolved to become so much more than just that. It's now a thriving melting pot of culture, expression and identity for a generation of web natives who skipped the whole "portal" and "homepage" era of the web. Its biggest user demographic is in the 18 to 24 bracket - people who dictate online trends.

The product was deemed to have enough potential to justify a billion dollar takeover bid from Yahoo! So, in short, if you'd like to be rolling with the "it" crowd here are some tips you need to master.



Search on any tumblr blog

A lot of Tumblr blogs out there do not have a search box. Fret not, there is an easy way to search these blogs. In the URL of the blog, append / search/[your search term] and press enter.

Eg:- [Blog Name].tumblr.com/search/iphone



Share stuff easily

The simplest and quickest way to share a link, photo, or anything for that matter on Tumblr is to use the Bookmarklet provided by Tumblr. It is a simple JavaScript code that you can add to your browser bookmarks bar. To share away to glory go to tumblr.com/apps and click and drag the 'Share on Tumblr' button to your bookmarks bar. The next time you want to share something that you are browsing or simply want to post an opinion on Tumblr, click the 'Share on Tumblr' button on the bookmarks bar and a Tumblr pop-up window will open to do your bidding.



Tumblr experience can be customised with extensions